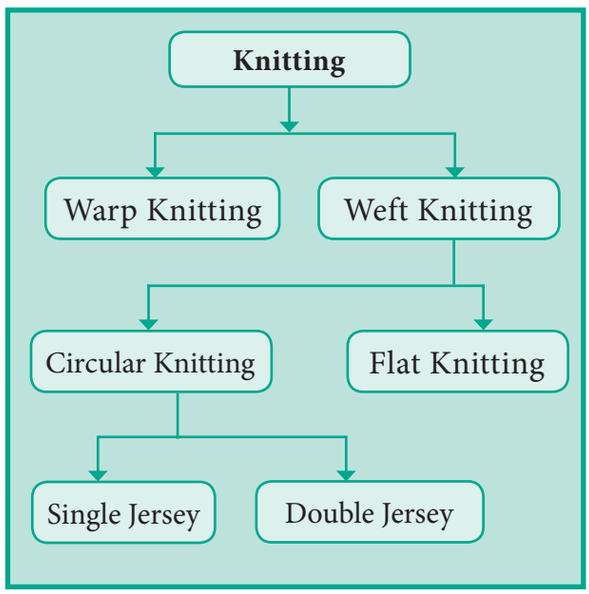
5.5 KNITTING

The second most important fabric construction method after weaving is knitting. Knitting is the process of making loops and throwing the yarns through loops to form a fabric. In the earlier days knitting was considered as a unique technique of making fabric using wool fibres. The oldest knitted products are socks found in Egypt tombs. Knitting is done using long stick like needles. The first knitting machine was invented in 1589, by Reverend William Lee. It slowly developed and today the market is filled with complex knitting machine to produce a huge range of knitted fabric.

5.5.1 Classification of Knitting

Knitting is divided into two main groups as warp and weft knitting. Warp knitted fabrics are produced by a series of yarn forming loops in the lengthwise direction of the fabric. Weft knitted fabrics is produced when one continuous yarn forms the loops in the crosswise directions. The most common types of warp knitt fabrics are Tricot knit, Raschel, Milanese and Simples knit. The different kinds of weft knits are plain, purl and rib. Both weft and warp knitting can be incorporated in the jacquard mechanism to produce fancy knitted fabrics.



5.5.2 Knitted Fabric Making

Knitted fabric is constructed by forming the yarns into loops. The vertical rows of loops stitches in knit fabric are known as wales and the horizontal rows of loops are called courses. The loops are formed by a group of needles or shafts, which are arranged one after the other in the knitting machine on the needle plate. The needles are evenly placed. Sinker is used to pull the needles down, which pulls the yarn into the previous loop. The knitted fabric is pulled down and rolled at the base of the machine and collected for further use.



Figure 5.15 Uses of Knitting

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